NNN-T-189B
July 2, 1976
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. NNN-T-189A
January 23, 1963

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TEST TUBE, LABORATORY, GLASS

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers glass test tubes for laboratory use.

1.2 Classification. Test tubes covered by this specification shall be of the following types, styles and sizes, as specified (see 6.1).

1.2.1 Types. Type I shall be applicable to all styles of test tubes; type II shall be applicable to style I only.

Type I - Borosilicate glass
Type II - Soda lime glass

1.2.2 Styles and sizes. Sizes, as shown, are dimensions--diameter and length in millimeters (mm.).

Style I--Cultural, general purpose.

Size 1 - 6 by 50	Size 7 - 18 by 150
Size 2 - 10 by 75	Size 8 - 20 by 150
Size 3 - 12 by 75	Size 9 - 25 by 150
Size 4 - 13 by 100	Size 10 - 25 by 200
Size 5 - 15 by 125	Size 11 - 32 by 200
Size 6 -16 by 150	

Style II--Ignition, heavy-walled.

Size 1 - 10 by 70	Size 3 - 18 by 150
Size 2 - 14 by 100	Size 4 - 25 by 200

FSC 6640

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Style III- With plastic screwcap.

Size 1	- 16 by 125	Size 3	- 20 by 150
Size 2	- 20 by 125	Size 4	- 25 by 150

Class A Screwcap with liner
Class B One-piece screwcap

Style IV- Glass stoppered.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

DD-G-541	-	Glass (Laboratory).
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665	-	Box, Paperboard, Metal-Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676	-	Box, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding pruposes are available without charge from the Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Washington, DC, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

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Military Specifications:

MIL-L-10547	-	Liners, Case, and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standards:

C 148	-	Polariscopic Examination of Glass Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101.)

Commercial Standard

CS 21	-	Interchangeable Taper-Ground Joints, Stopcocks, Stoppers and Spherical-Ground Joints.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Glass Containers Manufacturers Institute (GCMI)

Tall Continuous Thread Concealed Bead Finish.
Glass Finish Drawing Nos. 410, 415.

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(Application for copies of GCMI Standards should be addressed to the Glass Containers Manufacturers Institute, Attn: C.E. Wagner, 330 Madison Avenue, New York, NY 10017.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Glass.

3.1.1.1 Type I. Borosilicate glass shall conform to requirements of type I, class A or B of DD-G-541.

3.1.1.2 Type II. Soda lime glass shall conform to the requirements of type II of DD-G-541.

3.1.2 Plastic. Class A screwcaps shall be molded of phenol formaldehyde-type resin which is free of cellulose acetate and urea. Class B screwcaps shall be molded of polypropylene resin.

3.1.3 Lining. Liners for class A screwcaps shall be fabricated of resilient rubber.

3.2 Design.

3.2.1 Shape. Test tubes covered by this specification shall be tubular, with one end having a rounded closure.

3.2.1.1 Styles I and II. The open end of styles I and II test tubes shall be lipless, squared, and fire-polished. The walls of style II test tubes shall be heavier than style I, as specified in table I.

3.2.1.2 Style III. The open end of style III test tubes shall have a standard GCMI thread finish made to accommodate a plastic screw-on type cap. The inner edge of the cap shall be sufficiently threaded with a continuous thread formed as an integral part of the cap. The cap shall form a close fit with the tube to prevent loss of the contents. Class A screwcaps shall be lined with a tight-fitting, cemented-in rubber liner. Class B screwcaps shall be one-piece and shall contain no liner. Dimensions and thread finishes of the test tubes shall be as shown in table I.

3.2.1.3 Style IV. The open end of style IV test tubes shall have a standard taper joint to receive a standard taper stopper. This stopper shall be size number 8 or 9. The joint and stopper shall conform to CS21. Dimensions shall be as shown in table I.

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TABLE I. Dimensional requirements for test tubes

Classification			Test tube outside diameter	Test tube length[1/]	Test tube wall thickness [2/]	Thread finish (GCMI)[3/]
Style	Type	Size	Millimeter	Millimeter	Millimeter	
I	I, II	1	6 ± 0.5	50	0.8	
I	I, II	2	10 ± 0.5	75	0.9	
I	I, II	3	12 ± 0.5	75	0.9	
I	I, II	4	13 ± 0.5	100	0.9	
I	I, II	5	15 ± 0.5	125	1.0	
I	I, II	6	16 ± 0.5	150	1.0	
I	I, II	7	18 ± 0.5	150	1.0	
I	I, II	8	20 ± 0.8	150	1.0	
I	I, II	9	25 ± 0.8	150	1.2	
I	I, II	10	25 ± 0.8	200	1.2	
I	I, II	11	32 ± 1.5	200	1.2	
II	I	1	10 ± 0.5	70	1.75 ± 0.25	
II	I	2	14 ± 0.5	100	1.75 ± 0.25	
II	I	3	18 ± 0.5	150	1.75 ± 0.25	
II	I	4	25 ± 0.8	200	1.75 ± 0.25	
III	I, II[4/]	1	16 ± 0.5	125	1.2	415-15
III	I	2	20 ± 0.5	125	1.2	415-18
III	I	3	20 ± 0.5	150	1.2	415-18
III	I	4	25 ± 0.5	150	1.2	410-24
IV	I	-	13 ± 0.5	100	1.2	

1/ Tolerance - ± 2.5 mm.

2/ Tolerance - ± 0.2 mm., unless otherwise specified. Thickness of bottom shall be not less than 75% of the wall thickness.

3/ Applies only to style III.

4/ Inside diameter at open end shall be at least 9.25 mm.

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3.3 Strain. Ring and longitudinal strain shall be no greater than temper no. 1 when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.4 Resistance to autoclaving, style III. Screwcaps shall not deform, crack, turn color or become tacky, and class A rubber liners shall not detach or become tacky when tested as specified in 4.4.2. Assembled tube shall not leak when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.5 Leakage, styles II and IV. Tubes shall not leak when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.6 Area for marking. Side walls of type I tubes, except style I, sizes 1, 8, 9, 10 and 11, shall have an area which provides for marking. This area shall be enameled or roughened by blasting. If enamel is used, area shall not be removed when tested as specified in 4.4.4.1. Slight dulling shall not be considered cause for rejection.

3.7 Identification marking. Each test tube, except style I, size 1, shall be permanently and legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark. Marking shall not be removed when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Test tubes shall be free of defects listed in table IV or any other defects which may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

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4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificate of quality. Certificate of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the glass, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table II.

TABLE II. Sampling for examination

	Unit of product	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
For visual examination			
Major A defects	Tube	II	2.5
Major B defects	Cap	II	2.5
Major C defects	Stopper	II	2.5
Minor A defects	Tube, Cap and stopper	II	4.0
Minor B defects	Tube	II	4.0
For dimensional examination	Tube	S-2	6.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table III. Acceptance number shall be zero.

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TABLE III. Sampling for tests

Unit of product	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level
Tube and stopper	Strain	3.3	4.4.1	S-2
Tube and cap, style III only	Resistance to autoclaving	3.4	4.4.2	S-2
Tube and cap, Tube and stopper, styles III and IV only	Leakage	3.5	4.4.3	S-2
Tube and stopper	Permanency of marking	3.2.1.3 3.6, 3.7	4.4.4	S-2 *

* Equal number shall be used for each procedure. Additional samples shall be taken if necessary to provide for equality.

4.3 Examination. The tubes, caps and stoppers shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be in accordance with but shall not be limited to the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE IV. Classification of defects

Category	Defect
Major A:	
101	Tube not free of deformation.
102	Tube not free of chips.
103	Tube not free of cracks or breakage.
104	Tube not free of open air lines.
105	Tube not free of sharp or rough edges.
106	Tube not free of protrusions.
107	Tube not free of open blisters.
108	Designation marking not correct or legible (style IV only).
Major B:	
131	Cap not fitting on tube.
132	Cap not free of cracks.
133	Cap not free of deformation.
134	Liner not adhering (class A only).

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects (cont'd)

Category	Defects
Major C:	
171	Stopper not free of deformation.
172	Stopper not free of chips.
173	Stopper not free of cracks or breakage.
174	Stopper not free of open bubbles.
175	Stopper not free of sharp or rough edges.
176	Stopper not free of protrusions.
177	Stopper not free of open blisters.
178	Stopper not fitting in tube.
179	Designation marking not correct or legible.
Minor A:	
201	Tube, cap or stopper not free of dirt and other foreign matter. Packing material particles shall not be cause for rejection.
Minor B:	
251	Identification marking not complete, correct or legible.

4.4.1 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Strain. Tubes and stoppers shall be tested in accordance with ASTM C148, method A or B.

4.4.2 Autoclaving. Tubes with screwcaps secured shall be subjected to 3 consecutive autoclaving cycles at 15 pounds per square inch for 30 minutes. Capped test tubes shall be removed after each autoclaving cycle and allowed to cool for 30 minutes before repeating the heating cycle. Autoclaved tubes and caps shall be subjected to leakage test (see 4.4.3).

4.4.3 Leakage test. Test tubes shall be filled with water, and closure (screwcap or stopper) shall be applied handtight. Filled tubes shall be placed in an inverted position and allowed to stand for 30 minutes.

4.4.4 Permanency of marking. A different test tube and stopper shall be used for each of the following tests.

4.4.4.1 Resistance to alkali. The test tube shall be immersed completely in 1 N sodium hydroxide at room temperature, covered, boiled for 1/2 hour, and allowed to stand in the alkali for an additional hour. The test tube shall then be removed from the alkali, thoroughly rinsed with distilled water and dried by rubbing vigorously with a cloth.

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4.4.4.2 Resistance to acid.

4.4.4.2.1 Hydrochloric acid. The test tube shall be immersed completely in concentrated hydrochloric acid (specific gravity 1.18) at room temperature, covered, boiled for 1/2 hour, and allowed to stand for 1-1/2 hours in the acid. The test tube shall then be removed, thoroughly rinsed with distilled water and dried by rubbing vigorously with a cloth.

4.4.4.2.2 Sulfuric acid. The test tube shall be immersed completely in concentrated sulfuric acid (specific gravity 1.84) at room temperature and allowed to stand one hour. The test tube shall then be removed, thoroughly rinsed with distilled water and dried by rubbing vigorously with a cloth.

4.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in table V. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 percent defective.

TABLE V. Examination of preparation for delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging and packing materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence or method of application.

4.5.1 Examination of closure, waterproofing and banding. When containers are required to comply with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure, waterproofing and banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of the appropriate specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

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5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package.

5.1.1.1.1 Type I, style I, sizes 1, 3, 4, 5 and 6; type I, style II, size 4; type I, style I, size 2. One unit (12 tubes) shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-665, PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Box shall be provided with full-height chipboard partitions of suitable weight, so arranged that each tube shall be securely held in an individual cell. Closure of box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening. As an alternate, 12 tubes may be packaged in a diecut or molded polystyrene tray. Each tube shall be nested in an individual compartment. A paperboard pad shall be placed on top of the tubes and the complete package shall be shrink-wrapped in plastic film.

5.1.1.1.2 Type I, style III. One unit (12 tubes) shall be horizontally packaged in a box of appropriate size and design. When tubes are packaged in more than one layer, a paperboard divider shall be used to separate the layers. Twelve caps shall be packaged in a plastic bag and placed at the extreme end of the box. Closure of box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.1.1.3 Type I, style IV. The glass stopper shall be inserted into the mouth of the tube with a strip of paper between the wall of the tube and the stopper or the stopper may be placed in a paper tube by itself. Each tube with stopper shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. Box shall be designed with suitable interior fittings or shall contain sufficient cushioning material to insure against shifting or or damage to the contents. Closure shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.1.1.4 Type III, style III, size 1. One unit (144 tubes) shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size and design constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Screwcap shall be loosely applied to the tube. The box shall be provided with full-height, half-slotted style partitions, snug-fitting cell of each tube. Closure of box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate package. Unless otherwise specified, the number of units specified in table VI, shall be intermediately packaged in a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure of box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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TABLE VI. Packaging and packing quantities

Type	Style	Size	Unit of issue	Quantity per unit of issue	Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
I	III	-	Package	12	1 unit	6 units	48 units
I	IV	-	Each	1	1 unit	12 units	288 units
I	I	1	Package	12	1 unit	12 units	288 units
I	I	3	Package	12	1 unit	12 units	144 units
I	I	4	Package	12	1 unit	12 units	144 units
I	I	5	Package	12	1 unit	60 units	120 units
I	I	6	Package	12	1 unit	12 units	144 units
I	II	4	Package	12	1 unit	12 units	24 units
I	I	11	Package	12	1 unit	6 units	18 units
I	I	9	Package	12	1 unit	12 units	36 units
II	III	1	Package	144	1 unit	None	8 units

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I, style I, sizes 3, 4, 5 and 6. Seventy two test tubes shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be provided with fiberboard or molded polystyrene fittings to prevent shifting of or damage to the contents. The box shall be closed to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2.2 Type I, style III, sizes 1, 2, 3 and 4. Forty eight test tubes with a screw cap loosely applied to each test tube shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1.

5.1.3 Level C. Test tubes shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified, the number of units specified in table VI shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2 or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Fiberboard box shall be waterproof as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

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5.2.2 Level B. Unless otherwise specified, the number of units specified in table VI shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.2.1 Packages specified in 5.1.2 in the quantity as specified shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Units shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking for shipment shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. Each unit and intermediate package and exterior container shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type, style and size required (see 1.2).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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VA-DMS

Project No. 6640-0980

Preparing activity:

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